PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota 4Runner 5th Gen

2010–2024 · N280 · 1GR-FE

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Frame and underbody corrosion**
  Salt-belt and coastal trucks need a proper crawl underneath: frame rails, crossmembers, suspension mounts and the KDSS hard lines along the frame. Surface scale can be cleaned and treated (Trail4R's corrosion guide walks through it); flaking, holed metal is a different conversation.
- [ ] **KDSS health**
  On Trail and TRD Off-Road trucks, look for wet KDSS cylinders, weeping lines or a truck that leans. Owners on Expedition Portal describe leaking cylinders as difficult and expensive to fix. If it's lifted, ask how the KDSS was handled — Trail4R notes most lifts aren't designed around it.
- [ ] **Open recalls**
  Run the VIN at NHTSA. The big ones are the Takata passenger airbag inflator recalls covering 2010–2016 4Runners (19V-005, 19V-741 and earlier campaigns) and the Denso low-pressure fuel pump recalls for 2014–2015 (20V-012) and 2018–2019 trucks (20V-682).
- [ ] **Lift quality and CV boots**
  A lifted IFS truck runs steeper axle angles. Check for torn CV boots and grease slung around the wheel well, aftermarket upper control arms on bigger lifts, and an alignment record. Trail4R's writer tore CV boots repeatedly from excessive droop until fitting limit straps.
- [ ] **Front axle seals**
  Gear oil where the CV axle enters the front differential means a leaking axle seal. It's a DIY job, but budget for it and check the diff level.
- [ ] **Driveline fluid history**
  Ask for transmission (Toyota ATF WS only), differential and transfer case service records. Toyota's severe-service schedule changes diff oil every 15,000 miles when towing or loaded; many owners just do everything at about 30,000.
- [ ] **Rear window and liftgate**
  Run the power rear glass all the way down and up. A window that bounces back as if obstructed often just needs re-initialising or its tracks cleaned (see repairs), but a dead motor or regulator is a bigger job.
- [ ] **Pick your year**
  Autotrader says the fifth gen has no major issues and recommends a late truck, preferably 2020–24 (TSS-P standard and CarPlay). 2014+ gets the facelift, better brake lines and Trailer Sway Control. SlashGear flags 2013–2016 for higher complaint and recall counts. The 2.7 four was 2WD-only and 2010-only.

YEARS TO KNOW

2020	SWEET SPOT	Toyota Safety Sense-P standard; Entune 3.0 with Apple CarPlay and Android Auto. Autotrader says buy a late fifth gen, preferably 2020–2024

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator**
  2010–2011 · NHTSA 16V-340
- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator**
  2012 · NHTSA 17V-006
- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator**
  2010, 2013 · NHTSA 18V-024
- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator**
  2011–2016 · NHTSA 19V-005
- ☐ **Takata replacement inflators (re-recall)**
  2010–2016 · NHTSA 19V-741
- ☐ **Denso low-pressure fuel pump**
  2014–2015 · NHTSA 20V-012
- ☐ **Denso low-pressure fuel pump (expansion)**
  2018–2019 · NHTSA 20V-682

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Model codes**
  GRN280/285 for the 4.0 1GR-FE V6; TRN280 is the 2010-only 2.7 four on 2WD trucks.
- ☐ **Rear locker and KDSS**
  The factory e-locker and Crawl Control come on the Trail (2010–16) and TRD Off-Road (2017–24). KDSS was offered with the Trail; look for the hydraulic cylinders and lines on the sway bars.
- ☐ **Real TRD Pro**
  Introduced for 2015 with TRD-tuned Bilstein remote-reservoir shocks (Fox dampers on later trucks), TRD front springs and a TRD skid plate. Each year had an exclusive colour: Inferno Orange (2015), Quicksand (2016), Cement (2017), Cavalry Blue (2018), Voodoo Blue (2019), Army Green (2020), Lunar Rock (2021), Lime Rush (2022), Solar Octane (2023), Terra (2024).
- ☐ **Limited and TRD Sport**
  The Limited has full-time 4WD and X-REAS; the 2022-on TRD Sport also has X-REAS and 20 in wheels but only 2WD or part-time 4WD.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/4runner/5th-gen/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks